



HS 353: Science, Technology and Society

Course Code	HS 353
Course Name	Science, Technology and Society
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	Consent of the faculty member
Intended for	B.Tech
Approval	2nd Adhoc Senate (May 2012)

Course Contents

- **Module I** Importance of science and technology; The nature and philosophy of science; Structure of scientific revolution; Science and Scientific community; The rights and wrongs of science Case studies [10 Lectures]
- **Module II** The nature and philosophy of technology; Technology and the character of everyday life; Humans versus computers; The technological life world; Technology as a shadow constitution [10 Lectures]
- **Module III** Controversies regarding science and technology; Science, technology and the less-developed countries; technology and transformation of work; Science, technology and economic theory; Science, democracy and stem cells [10 Lectures]
- **Module IV** The Science wars: Debating scientific knowledge and technology; History of Indian science and technology; Science and Technology policy making in India: An overview [8 Lectures]

Readings

1. Albert Borgmann, **Technology and the Character of Contemporary Life**, University of Chicago Press, 1987.
2. Bruno Latour, **Laboratory Life: The Construction of Scientific Facts**, Princeton University Press, 1986.
3. Chalmers A.F., **What is this thing called Science**, University of Queensland Press, 1999.
4. Don Ihde., **Existential Technics**, State University of New York Press.
5. **American Philosophy of Technology: The Empirical Turn**, Indiana University Press;
6. Jacques Ellul., **The Technological Society**, Vintage Books, 1967.
7. Keith Parsons, **The Science Wars: Debating Scientific Knowledge and Technology**, Prometheus Books, 2003.
8. Martin Bridgstock(Ed), **Science, Technology and Society: An Introduction**, Cambridge University Press, 1998.
9. Rudi Volti, **Society and Technological Change**, 6th Edition, Worth Publishers, 2008.
10. Wenda K. Bauchspies, **Science, Technology and Society: A Sociological Approach**, Blackwell Publishers, 2005.